FIELD WORKBOOK VOL. 01

PRIVATE · OFFLINE · YOURS

> You don't need to prepare for the apocalypse. You need to cover the gap between when something goes wrong and when help arrives. Paper doesn't need a battery. Fill this out once, review it every quarter.

72 hrs	3 days	4–8 hrs	~$100
FEMA'S MINIMUM · SUSTAIN YOURSELVES THREE DAYS	AVERAGE GROCERY STOCK AT NORMAL DEMAND	CELL TOWER BATTERY BACKUP, NOT DAYS	WATER, FOOD, LIGHT AND A PLAN

72 hrs: FEMA Citizen Preparedness Guide, p. 17–18. Remaining three figures: nomad-core.com/blog/72-hour-gap.

THIS BOOK BELONGS TO

CONTAINS NO PASSWORDS AND NO ACCOUNT NUMBERS — IF FOUND, PLEASE RETURN

HOUSEHOLD NAME _____

CONTACT NUMBER _____

HOME ADDRESS _____

COUNTY _____

PRINTED _____

LAST FULL REVIEW _____

NEXT REVIEW DUE _____

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REFERENCE CARDS

Cut these out. One goes on the fridge, one in each vehicle, one in the go-bag. Print this sheet separately on card stock so cutting it does not take a page out of the binder.

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES — card stock if you have it, laminate if you can

POWER OUTAGE

- Anyone drowsy, confused or unresponsive near a running engine: call 911, get them outside
- Generator outside only, 20 ft from the house, exhaust pointed away
- Main breaker OFF before the generator breaker goes ON
- Stop the engine and let it cool before refuelling
- CO has no smell. Headache, dizziness or nausea means get out now

NEVER
Indoors, in a garage, or under an open window · Backfeed through a wall outlet · Refuel a hot engine

WILDFIRE

- 911 for a fire threatening the house. Report it even if you are leaving
- Go early, on the route already chosen
- Close every window, door and blind on the way out
- Shut the gas off at the valve
- Leave lights on so the house is visible through smoke

NEVER
Wait for the order · Try to outrun it

SNAKE BITE

- Call 911. Poison Control 1-800-222-1222
- Hospital now. Do not wait to see if symptoms develop
- Remove rings, watches and anything tight before swelling starts
- Elevate the limb 45° or more, knee and elbow kept straight
- Keep them calm and still. Nobody bitten drives
- Coral snake is the exception: position of comfort
- At hospital: if antivenom is withheld, ask for a medical toxicologist

NEVER
Let the limb hang below the heart · Tourniquet, constricting band or pressure wrap · Cut, suck, extraction device, ice or electric shock

HEAT

- Red, hot, dry skin, confusion, or no sweating: call 911. This is heat stroke
- Pale, moist skin, headache, dizziness: shade, loosen clothing, water on the skin, fan, sip water
- Cool hard and keep cooling all the way to the hospital

NEVER
Let anyone confused walk it off · Stop cooling because they look better

WATER FAILURE

- 911 only if someone is ill. Otherwise this is a supply problem, not an emergency
- Fill tubs, totes and every container while pressure still holds
- A rolling boil kills everything in it
- Or 8 drops of plain 5.25% bleach per gallon, then wait 30 minutes
- A faint chlorine smell means it worked. No smell, dose it again

NEVER
Scented, colour-safe or additive bleach · Assume rain or river water is drinkable

COMMUNICATIONS

- 911 emergency | 211 community services
- 988 suicide & crisis lifeline
- Poison Control 1-800-222-1222
- Any signal repeated three times reads as distress
- SOS is three short, three long, three short, sent unbroken and repeated

IF YOU HAVE NO RADIO

Ground symbols · I need medical help · II need supplies · X unable to proceed · F need food and water · → travelling this way

Symbol size · 1 metre wide by 6 metres long minimum, kept at that 1:6 ratio, in open ground that contrasts with the symbol

Scope and limits · Written for the United States · general preparedness information, not medical advice, and no substitute for emergency services or an evacuation order · sources including FEMA and Hesperian are cited for provenance only and endorse nothing here

Sources. Generator siting, breaker sequence, backfeed — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 178-183 (proc. 2656). Carbon monoxide symptoms — FM 31 70 Basic Cold Weather Manual, p. 49 (proc. 2447). House closure, early evacuation — All Hazard Preparedness Workbook, p. 40-41 (proc. 2013). Evacuating before routes block — FEMA Citizen Preparedness Guide, p. 13 (proc. 2259). Snake bite — Unified Treatment Algorithm for Crotaline Snakebite, Lavonas et al., BMC Emerg Med 2011; Greene S, wsed.org (proc. 49001). Heat exhaustion — FM 4 25 11 First Aid, 5-4 to 5-5 (proc. 2481). Heat stroke — FM 4 25 11 First Aid, 5-5 to 5-6 (proc. 2482). Heat stroke, further reading — Where There is no Doctor a Village Health Care Handbook, p. 81 (proc. 3284). Boiling — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 112-113 (proc. 2658). Bleach dosage and contact time — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 118-120 (proc. 2660). Rule of three, Morse SOS — Signaling And Direction Finding, p. 6-7 (proc. 2830). Ground symbols, 1:6 sizing — Signaling And Direction Finding, p. 7 (proc. 2829). National numbers — public directory, check annually.

CUT AND PLACED BY _____ DATE _____ REPLACE BY _____

READINESS LEVELS

A score tells you how prepared you are. A level tells you what to do this afternoon. The triggers below are written for your hazard and your county. The three levels are not, and do not change.

THREE STATES

one level at a time, decided out loud, said to everyone

GREEN

NORMAL OPERATIONS

TRIGGERED BY

- No watch or warning posted for the county
- No incident within the area you would evacuate through

WHAT CHANGES

- Fuel kept above half a tank
- Go-bags packed and where they live
- Radios charged, weather radio on standby
- Documents backed up, one copy off site
- Batteries topped, water containers full

YELLOW

ELEVATED CONDITIONS

TRIGGERED BY

- A watch or warning is posted for the county
- Conditions favour the local hazard
- An incident is reported nearby but not moving toward you
- Routes you would use are already busy

WHAT CHANGES

- Top off fuel, water and the largest propane tank
- Stage the generator and cords where you can reach them in the dark
- Load priority items by the door, vehicles facing out
- Pre-cool or pre-heat the house while utility power is up
- Weather radio on continuously, check in on the hour
- Decide now who collects whom, and say it out loud

RED

ACTIVE THREAT

TRIGGERED BY

- The hazard is visible, or confirmed moving toward you
- An evacuation warning or order covers your area or one next to it
- Routes are beginning to congest

WHAT CHANGES

- Load and go, on the route already chosen
- Do not wait for the order. Waiting is what blocks the road
- Shut down non-essential systems, gas off at the valve if leaving
- Radio check on the hour, every hour, from wherever you are
- If a route is blocked, take the next one down. Do not improvise

Sources. Evacuating before an order is issued, and not outrunning a fire — All Hazard Preparedness Workbook, p. 40-41 (proc. 2013). Evacuating on notice to avoid blocked routes — FEMA Citizen Preparedness Guide, p. 13 (proc. 2259). Route planning and evacuation execution — FEMA Citizen Preparedness Guide, p. 16-17 (proc. 2257).

REGION CARD

The page nobody outside your county can write for you. Named hazards with dates, named roads, named hospitals. Fill it once, then check it whenever something here changes.

WHERE YOU ARE

verify the numbers annually, they drift

NAME	NUMBER	NOTES
County		
Emergency management		
Alert system you signed up for		
Nearest fire station		
Power utility / outage line		
Water utility		

HAZARDS THAT HAVE ACTUALLY HAPPENED HERE — WITH DATES

EVENT	YEAR	WHAT IT DID	WHAT CHANGED AFTER

ROUTES OUT

ROADS IN ORDER	CHOKEPOINTS TO AVOID	MILES	DRIVEN ON
West			
East			
South			
North			

HOSPITALS, IN THE ORDER YOU WOULD ACTUALLY USE THEM

	FACILITY	ADDRESS	DRIVE TIME	LEVEL / STOCKS ANTIVENOM
1				
2				
3				
4				

FILLED BY _____ DATE _____ VERIFIED AGAINST COUNTY _____

FIRST 30 MINUTES

Power is out and you do not yet know for how long. Work down this page in order. One person calls it out loud so everyone hears the same thing.

IN ORDER — life safety first, then the things that stop being possible

1 · LIFE SAFETY

Account for everyone · by name, out loud, including anyone expected home
Check the hazard · weather alert, smoke, water, gas smell. Decide if this is a stay or a go
If it is a go · stop here and work Form 07 RED and the Grab List instead

2 · WATER, WHILE PRESSURE STILL HOLDS

Fill everything · bathtubs, totes, bottles, kettles, the washing machine drum
Fill the filter · gravity filter topped up and a second vessel under it
Stop wasting it · no laundry, no dishwasher, flush on a rule from now on

3 · COLD CHAIN

Coldest setting · on every fridge and freezer while there is still grid power
Doors shut · consolidate into the fullest appliance, then leave them closed
Freeze water · any spare container. It buys cold later and drinks warm

4 · POWER

Charge now · phones, radios, battery banks, tool batteries, from the grid while it is up
Deploy solar · panels out and pointed before you need the charge, not after
Generator · outside, 20 ft from the house, exhaust away. Main breaker OFF before the generator breaker goes ON. Let it run five minutes at no load before you put the house on it

5 · COMMUNICATIONS

Weather radio on · and left on. It is the only source that does not need the network
One text out · to the out-of-area contact. Text survives congestion that voice does not
Set the check-in · say the times out loud, agree them, then stop transmitting

Sources. Filling and storing water before supply fails — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 111-123 (proc. 2649). Generator siting, main-breaker sequence and carbon monoxide — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 178-183 (proc. 2656). Cold storage temperature control — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 106 (proc. 2665). Immediate evacuation actions — All Hazard Preparedness Workbook, p. 6 (proc. 2003).

READINESS INDEX

Score yourself before you fill anything else in, then again after. The gap between the two numbers is the whole point of this book. 100 points total.

SCORE ONE LINE AT A TIME — check only what is true today

FAMILY & CONTACTS — 25 PTS

- ☐ Every household member is written down by name and date of birth — 5
- ☐ Every member has a working phone number recorded — 5
- ☐ One ICE contact is designated and that person knows it — 5
- ☐ Blood type, allergies and medications recorded for each member — 5
- ☐ Pets and service animals are listed with their needs — 5

MEETING PLACES — 20 PTS

- ☐ Primary rally point set, and everyone can walk to it — 7
- ☐ Alternate rally point set outside the immediate neighborhood — 7
- ☐ Out-of-town location set, more than one hour away — 6

COMMUNICATION — 20 PTS

- ☐ Out-of-state contact chosen and confirmed with that person — 7
- ☐ Local contact chosen and confirmed — 6
- ☐ Reunification plan written for when phones are down — 7

EVACUATION ROUTES — 20 PTS

- ☐ Primary route recorded and driven at least once — 10
- ☐ Alternate route recorded that avoids the primary's chokepoints — 10

DRILLS — 15 PTS

- ☐ Fire drill completed in the last 90 days — 8
- ☐ Evacuation drill completed in the last 90 days — 7

SCORE TODAY	SCORE AFTER FILLING BOOK	TOP 3 GAPS TO CLOSE FIRST
_____	_____	_____ _____ _____

WHAT CHANGED SINCE THE LAST REVIEW

_____

_____

_____

ENTERED BY _____ DATE _____ REVIEW DUE _____

PERSON RECORD

One sheet per household member. This is what a paramedic, a school office or a shelter volunteer will ask for. Copy this page as many times as you need people.

IDENTITY

no account numbers or passwords on this page

FULL LEGAL NAME

GOES BY

DATE OF BIRTH

HEIGHT

WEIGHT

BLOOD TYPE

MOBILE PHONE

EMAIL

MEDICAL

ALLERGIES — INCLUDE REACTION SEVERITY

MEDICATIONS — NAME, DOSE, HOW OFTEN, DAYS OF SUPPLY ON HAND

CONDITIONS AND PAST SURGERIES

PRIMARY CARE PHYSICIAN / PHONE

INSURANCE PROVIDER

MOBILITY NEEDS

DIETARY NEEDS

SENSORY / COGNITIVE NEEDS

WHERE THIS PERSON IS ON A NORMAL WEEKDAY

WORKPLACE OR SCHOOL — NAME AND ADDRESS

PHONE

HOURS ON SITE

GRADE / DEPARTMENT

WHO MAY PICK THEM UP

IN CASE OF EMERGENCY

ICE CONTACT NAME

RELATIONSHIP

PHONE

ONE THING THIS PERSON SHOULD NOT LEAVE WITHOUT — INHALER, GLASSES, INSULIN, A SPECIFIC TOY

Handling. This sheet holds medical information. Store it with your documents, not in a bag that leaves the house casually, and shred old versions rather than recycling them.

One sheet per person. Photocopy this page before filling it in. Everyone in the household gets their own, including the people who think they will not need one.

ENTERED BY _____ DATE _____ REVIEW DUE _____

RALLY POINTS

Four layers, ordered by how far things have gone wrong. Each one has to work when the one above it doesn't. That's the only test that matters.

P · A · C · E — write coordinates, not just addresses — street signs come down

P

PRIMARY — WALKABLE FROM HOME, IN SIGHT OF IT

PLACE _____ LAT / LONG _____

A

ALTERNATE — OUTSIDE THE NEIGHBORHOOD, REACHABLE ON FOOT

PLACE _____ LAT / LONG _____

WALKING TIME FROM HOME _____

C

CONTINGENCY — OUT OF TOWN, OVER ONE HOUR AWAY

PLACE _____ LAT / LONG _____

HOST NAME AND PHONE — CONFIRMED ON _____

E

EMERGENCY — DIFFERENT REGION, ASSUME YOU ARRIVE WITH NOTHING

PLACE _____ LAT / LONG _____

ROUTES OUT

USE	ROUTE — ROADS IN ORDER	CHOKEPOINTS TO AVOID	FUEL / WATER EN ROUTE	MILES	DRIVEN ON
1st					
2nd					
Foot					

UTILITY SHUTOFFS AT HOME

GAS — WHERE, AND WHAT TOOL _____

WATER — WHERE _____

ELECTRICAL PANEL — WHERE _____

Test it. A rally point nobody has physically stood at is a guess. Walk each of the first two with everyone in the household, including the children, before you call this page done.

GRAB LIST

Built by how much time you get, not by category. Decide now what gets left behind at thirty seconds, so nobody has to decide it later in the dark.

FOUR WINDOWS

each tier includes everything above it

30 SECONDS

IMMEDIATE THREAT — DO NOT PACK, GO

5 MINUTES

URGENT — PRIORITY 1 ITEMS ONLY

30 MINUTES

ORDERED — PACK SYSTEMATICALLY

2 HOURS

PRECAUTIONARY — PACK, SECURE, NOTIFY

PROMPTS, BY THE APP'S SIX PRIORITY GROUPS

- ☐ DOCUMENTS · IDs, passports, birth certificates
- ☐ DOCUMENTS · Insurance and medical records
- ☐ DOCUMENTS · Cash in small bills
- ☐ SURVIVAL · Water and filter
- ☐ SURVIVAL · Food that needs no cooking
- ☐ SURVIVAL · Flashlight and spare batteries
- ☐ FAMILY · Prescriptions and glasses
- ☐ FAMILY · First aid kit
- ☐ FAMILY · Baby supplies, pet food and records
- ☐ CLOTHING · Change of clothes, sturdy shoes
- ☐ CLOTHING · Blankets, rain layer
- ☐ TOOLS · Multi-tool, duct tape, whistle
- ☐ TOOLS · Paper map of the region
- ☐ TOOLS · Radio and power bank
- ☐ COMFORT · One item per child

WHO CARRIES WHAT

PERSON	THEIR BAG LIVES	THEY CARRY	WEIGHT CHECK

Weight check. Keep a loaded bag under a quarter of the carrier's body weight, and less for children and anyone with a mobility limit. Load the bags, then walk a mile before you believe the plan.

Sources. Four time windows and the six priority groups — NomadCore app, EmergencyPlanService.getEvacuationScenarios(), src/services. Pack weight under a quarter of body weight — Web supplied information, Wirecutter Go Bag, Uncharted Supply Co. (proc. 3155).

POWER & FUEL PLAN

Running on generator and battery for days is a different problem from getting through an evening. Decide the order you shed loads now, while nobody is hot and tired.

LOAD SHEDDING LADDER

1 is the last thing you give up

	LOAD	RUNNING WATTS	RUNS ON	GIVE IT UP WHEN
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

A DAY ON GENERATOR AND BATTERY

SOURCE	WHAT RUNS	NOTES
Morning		
Midday		
Evening		
Night		

FUEL

GASOLINE TARGET, AND WHERE IT IS STORED

PROPANE TARGET IN POUNDS, NOT TANK COUNT — TANK SIZES DIFFER

ROTATION INTERVAL, AND THE DATE LAST ROTATED

MINIMUM TANK SIZE THE GENERATOR REQUIRES

GENERATOR SAFETY, EVERY SINGLE TIME

Siting · outdoors only, at least 20 ft from the house, exhaust pointed away, never in a garage or under a window even with the door open

Carbon monoxide · no smell, no warning. Headache, dizziness, nausea or confusion means get everyone into open air first and ask questions second

Connection · main breaker off before the generator breaker goes on. A transfer switch or interlock, never a cord into a wall outlet

Refuelling · engine stopped and cool. Store fuel away from heat and use stabiliser in anything that will sit

Known gap. A grid-tied rooftop array shuts down when the grid does, by design and by code, and produces nothing during the outage it was bought for. Fixing it needs an inverter that can island, which is a purchase rather than a plan. Record the gap here and the cost so it is a decision rather than a surprise.

Sources. Generator siting, carbon monoxide, backfeed and refuelling — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 178-183 (proc. 2656). Generator operation, extension cord sizing and load management — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 178-182 (proc. 2669). Carbon monoxide symptoms and ventilation — FM 31 70 Basic Cold Weather Manual, p. 49 (proc. 2447). Generator start sequence and load order — disaster handbook procedures, Disaster Handbook (proc. 2143).

WATER & SANITATION PLAN

Water is the first thing to run out and the last thing you can improvise. Sanitation is the one people plan for last and regret first.

SOURCES, IN THE ORDER YOU WOULD USE THEM

	SOURCE	CAPACITY	TREATMENT NEEDED	HOW YOU MOVE IT
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

DAILY ALLOCATION, PER PERSON

DRINKING _____

COOKING _____

HYGIENE _____

SANITATION _____

SURVIVAL RATE PER DAY, WHOLE HOUSEHOLD _____

CONSERVATION RATE PER DAY, WHOLE HOUSEHOLD _____

TREATMENT

Boiling · a rolling boil is enough. It kills everything and leaves no protection against recontamination, so store it covered

Bleach · 8 drops of plain 5.25% sodium hypochlorite per gallon of clear water, 30 minutes contact. A faint chlorine smell means it worked; no smell means dose again. Never scented or colour-safe

Filtering first · cloudy water is pre-filtered through cloth before either method, or the treatment is working on mud

Rainwater · is not potable as collected. It is a source, not a supply

WHEN THE SEPTIC OR THE SEWER STOPS

WHERE WASTE GOES ON DAY ONE, AND ON DAY SEVEN _____

WHAT YOU HAVE FOR IT — BAGS, BUCKET, LIME, COVER MATERIAL _____

HANDWASHING STATION: WHERE IT IS, AND WHO REFILLS IT _____

Sources. Boiling as purification — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 112-113 (proc. 2658). Bleach dosage and contact time — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 118-120 (proc. 2660). Water storage and handling — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 111-123 (proc. 2649). Emergency sanitation and waste management — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 175-177 (proc. 2651). Human waste disposal when sewerage stops — All Hazard Preparedness Workbook, p. 22-23 (proc. 2005).

FOOD PLAN

Eat in the order things spoil, not in the order you fancy them. The plan is four phases and the only hard rule is the one about who takes the shortfall.

FOUR PHASES

move down only when the one above is gone

PHASE	DAYS	WHAT YOU ARE EATING	WHAT STARTS NOW
1			
2			
3			
4			

CALORIES PER PERSON PER DAY — YOUR TARGETS, NOT A STANDARD

PERSON	NORMAL	REDUCED ACTIVITY	FLOOR, NEVER GO UNDER

WHO ABSORBS A SHORTFALL FIRST, AND WHO NEVER DOES. WRITE THE NAMES, NOT THE PRINCIPLE

LONG-TERM STAPLES ON HAND

ITEM	QUANTITY	PACKED HOW	WHERE	ROTATE BY

COOKING WITHOUT POWER

PRIMARY, AND ITS FUEL

SECONDARY

LAST RESORT

One-pot bias. Meals that cook in one vessel use less fuel, less water and less washing up, and all three of those are rationed at the same time. Plan the menu around the pot, not the recipe.

Sources. Food storage basic requirements and packing — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 22-23 (proc. 2648). Storage quantity planning — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 108-109, 206-207 (proc. 2676). Storage temperature control — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 106 (proc. 2665). Rotation system — FRC Preparedness Handbook, p. 94-97 (proc. 2595). Oxygen absorber usage — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 91-93 (proc. 2650).

INVENTORY & ROTATION

Supplies you own but can't find are supplies you don't own. Location and expiry matter as much as quantity.

STOCK ON HAND

criticality 1–10 · nine and above is essential

ITEM	CATEGORY	QTY	WHERE IT LIVES	CRIT	EXPIRES	LAST CHECKED

CATEGORIES, SAME TWELVE THE APP USES

HOME · house stores
PANTRY · food on shelf
CAR · vehicle kit
PACK · hiking pack
WATER · water & filtration
FOOD · rations & cooking
MEDICAL · first aid & meds
TOOLS · tools & repair
SHELTER · tent, tarp, bedding
POWER · batteries & charging
WARMTH · fire, light, layers
GENERAL · everything else

EXPIRING IN THE NEXT 90 DAYS

_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____

Rotate, don't discard. Move near-date food and batteries into everyday use and replace with fresh stock. Nothing should expire in a bin.

Sources. The twelve categories — NomadCore app, PackMind default categories, src/screens/PackMindScreen.tsx.

ENTERED BY _____ DATE _____ REVIEW DUE _____

MAINTENANCE SCHEDULE

Equipment that has not been run in a year is not equipment, it is an assumption. Work this by cadence and write the date down, because memory is the thing that fails first.

BY CADENCE, NOT BY MACHINE — the question you actually ask is: what is due this month

EVERY MONTH — 14 CHECKS

- ☐ Batteries | Check charge level
- ☐ Batteries | Check water levels (flooded lead-acid)
- ☐ CO alarms | Test alarm
- ☐ Extinguisher | Check accessibility
- ☐ Extinguisher | Shake (dry chemical)
- ☐ Extinguisher | Visual inspection
- ☐ First aid | Restock used items
- ☐ Generator | Check oil level
- ☐ Generator | Run for 15-30 minutes
- ☐ Smoke alarms | Test alarm
- ☐ Solar | Check inverter operation
- ☐ Solar | Visual inspection
- ☐ Water filter | Check pressure gauges
- ☐ Weather radio | Test radio

EVERY QUARTER — 11 CHECKS

- ☐ Batteries | Clean terminals (lead-acid)
- ☐ Batteries | Full charge cycle
- ☐ Batteries | Inspect for swelling or damage
- ☐ First aid | Check expiration dates
- ☐ Generator | Add fuel stabilizer or drain fuel
- ☐ Generator | Check battery (if electric start)
- ☐ Generator | Check/clean air filter
- ☐ Solar | Clean panels
- ☐ Water filter | Replace sediment pre-filter
- ☐ Weather radio | Replace/charge batteries
- ☐ Weather radio | Test hand crank (if equipped)

LESS OFTEN — DIARISE ONCE, THEN FORGET THEM

Batteries · Test capacity (6 mo)
CO alarms · Replace batteries (6 mo) · Replace unit (5 yr)
Extinguisher · Professional inspection (1 yr) · Hydrostatic test (6 yr)
First aid · Full inventory check (6 mo) · Check container condition (6 mo)
Generator · Change oil (6 mo) · Check spark plug (6 mo) · Inspect fuel lines and connections (6 mo) · Replace air filter (1 yr) · Replace spark plug (1 yr) · Professional service (1 yr)
Smoke alarms · Replace batteries (6 mo) · Clean/vacuum (6 mo) · Replace unit (10 yr)
Solar · Check connections and wiring (6 mo) · Trim vegetation (6 mo) · Professional inspection (1 yr)
Water filter · Replace main filter (6 mo) · Sanitize system (1 yr)
Water storage · Rotate stored water (6 mo) · Inspect containers (6 mo) · Check water treatment supplies (6 mo)
Weather radio · Verify SAME codes programmed (1 yr)

PASS LOG — THE USEFUL OUTPUT IS WHAT FAILED

DATE	BY	WHAT FAILED OR WAS MISSING	FIXED BY / WHEN

Generated, not typed. These items come from the app's own maintenance templates, so the printed book and the app cannot drift apart. Add what you actually own, delete what you do not. An interval you never meet is worse than a longer one you keep.

Sources. Maintenance items and intervals — MaintenanceTemplates.ts, NomadCore app source, checked September 2026.

COMMUNICATIONS CARD

Local lines fail before long-distance ones. Route through someone far away, and agree the plan while everyone can still hear each other.

HUMAN NETWORK

OUT-OF-STATE CONTACT — EVERYONE CALLS THIS PERSON FIRST

LOCAL CONTACT — NEARBY, NOT IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD

REUNIFICATION PLAN — WHO COLLECTS WHOM, IN WHAT ORDER, AND WHEN TO STOP WAITING

RADIO PLAN

CHANNEL	FREQUENCY	USED FOR	CHECK-IN TIMES	CALLSIGN / CODE WORD
Primary				
Alternate				
Scanner				
Weather				

AGREED CODE WORDS

COME GET ME NOW

I AM SAFE, STAY PUT

I AM NOT ALONE / NOT FREE TO TALK

Before you transmit. Know which bands you are licensed for and keep to them. FCC rules permit any frequency to be used to call for help when life or property is in immediate danger, but that is the exception, not the plan.

Sources. Emergency use of any frequency — 47 CFR 97.403, FCC.

ENTERED BY DATE REVIEW DUE

DRILL LOG

A plan that has never been rehearsed is a document, not a plan. Run one each quarter and write down what broke. The broken parts are the useful output.

QUARTERLY CADENCE

mark the quarter when the drill is complete

Q1 · JAN–MAR	Q2 · APR–JUN	Q3 · JUL–SEP	Q4 · OCT–DEC

DRILL RECORDS

DATE	TYPE	WHO TOOK PART	TIME TO CLEAR	WHAT BROKE	FIXED BY / WHEN

DRILL TYPES WORTH RUNNING

- ☐ Fire — get everyone out, meet at the primary point
- ☐ Evacuation — grab bags, load vehicle, drive the route
- ☐ Blackout — one evening, no grid power, no exceptions
- ☐ Comms down — reunite with phones switched off
- ☐ Shelter in place — seal a room, ration for a day
- ☐ Water only — cook and clean from stored water

Debrief in five minutes. What took longer than expected, what nobody could find, and who was missing information. Log those three answers and one fix owner. That's the drill.

ENTERED BY _____ DATE _____ REVIEW DUE _____

LONG-DURATION OPERATIONS

Read this on a Sunday, not during an outage. It is the reasoning behind the other sheets, and the part that explains why the plan changes shape somewhere around day four.

THE FIRST THREE WEEKS

Week one · stabilise · burn what spoils, run equipment hard while fuel is plentiful, and find out what actually breaks. Almost everything you learn about your plan, you learn in the first four days

Week two · conserve · generator runtime drops, solar and battery carry more, and rationing becomes a routine instead of a decision. Fuel you did not burn in week one is the whole reason week two works

Week three and on · produce · consumption alone stops being viable. Anything that regenerates, water capture, eggs, a garden, stops being a hobby and starts being infrastructure

WHY ONE COOLED ROOM BEATS A COOLED HOUSE

Cooling the whole house on generator power is the single largest load in the plan, and in a Texas summer it is also the one that decides whether anyone sleeps. The compromise that works is thermal: run the air conditioning hard while the generator is already running for other reasons, bank the cold in the building's mass, then close down to one small interior room with few windows and let fans hold it overnight. A room you can isolate holds cold for hours after the machine that made it stops. Pick the room now, on a calm day, on the basis of windows and doors rather than whose bedroom it is, because that argument is much harder to have at midnight in August.

WHAT RUNS OUT FIRST, AND IT IS RARELY WHAT PEOPLE EXPECT

Households plan for food and run short of water, fuel and patience, usually in that order. Water goes first because the daily requirement is unforgiving and storage is bulky. Fuel goes next because generator consumption is estimated optimistically almost universally, and the only cure is to measure it once rather than assume it forever. Patience goes third: the plan that assumes everyone stays reasonable is the plan that has not been rehearsed. Every drill that ends badly is cheaper than the real thing ending badly, which is the entire argument for the drill log.

THE FAILURE THAT REPEATS

The most common preparedness failure is not a missing supply. It is equipment that was bought, never run, and assumed to work, or a procedure written once in two different registers so that the terse version and the careful version disagree and nobody notices until it matters. The drill log and the maintenance schedule exist to catch those two failures specifically. Neither is interesting. Both are the reason the rest of the book is worth printing.

Sources. Food storage quantity planning over extended periods — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 108-109, 206-207 (proc. 2676). Water storage and handling over extended periods — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 111-123 (proc. 2649). Generator maintenance and load management — LDS Preparedness Manual, p. 178-182 (proc. 2669).